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Fulfilled in Our Hearing: History and Method of Christian
Preaching (review)

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(Review)

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BRIEF NOTICES

DeBona, Guericc, OSB. *Fulfilled in Our Hearing: History and Method of Christian Preaching*. (New York and Mahwah, New Jersey: Paulist Press. 2005. Pp. xi, 228. \$19.95 paperback.)

The subtitle of *Fulfilled in Our Hearing* is a little misleading. It might better be phrased: "A History of the Methods of Modern Christian—Especially Catholic—Preaching." Indeed, the title itself makes allusion to the document *Fulfilled in Your Hearing: The Homily in the Sunday Assembly*, published by the National Council of Catholic Bishops in 1982, which has become a foundational document in Catholic homiletics. Guericc DeBona's book does trace the history of preaching—or more specifically the history of various methods of preaching, but it does so in a very cursory way until it reaches the last quarter of the twentieth century and the advent of what has come to be known as the New Homiletic. Even then it covers quickly what has been more fully described in Richard Eslinger's *A New Hearing* and *The Web of Preaching* or O. C. Edwards' *A History of Preaching*. However DeBona is writing primarily for a Catholic reader. It is when he turns his attention to Catholic preaching and more particularly to Catholic homiletic writing since the Second Vatican Council that he makes a unique contribution to the understanding of contemporary American Catholic approaches to preaching. He traces influences on Catholic homileticians coming from within the Catholic Community as well as from both the broader Christian academy and the wider culture. The book presents a good and helpful overview of the development of Catholic thought regarding preaching in the last forty years, paying special attention not only to the Eurocentric tradition with its focus on classic and contemporary mainstream theologies, but to black, Hispanic, and feminist approaches as well. Although narrow in focus, the book will prove a valuable resource for anyone doing research in contemporary history of Catholic liturgy and preaching as well as for those charged with the education of Catholic preachers. DONALD HEET, O.S.E.S. (*The Catholic University of America*)

Ganzer, Klaus. *Die religiösen Bewegungen im Italien des 16. Jahrhunderts*. [Katholisches Leben und Kirchenreform im Zeitalter der Glaubensspaltung. Vereinsschriften der Gesellschaft zur Herausgabe des Corpus Catholicorum, 63.] (Münster: Aschendorff Verlag. 2003. Pp. viii, 82. €17,40 paperback.)